A Guide to Doodling!

Welcome to My Doodle Game, a fun and creative game making tool. With it you can literally draw your own games and then have hours of fun playing them!

After installing My Doodle Game and running it, you will be presented with this introduction screen;



Selecting **PLAY** will then show you the list of games made with My Doodle Game – your own personal arcade!

The **EDIT** and **NEW** buttons take you to the main game editing environment for My Doodle Game. Here you can create your own doodle games from scratch or edit saved ones.

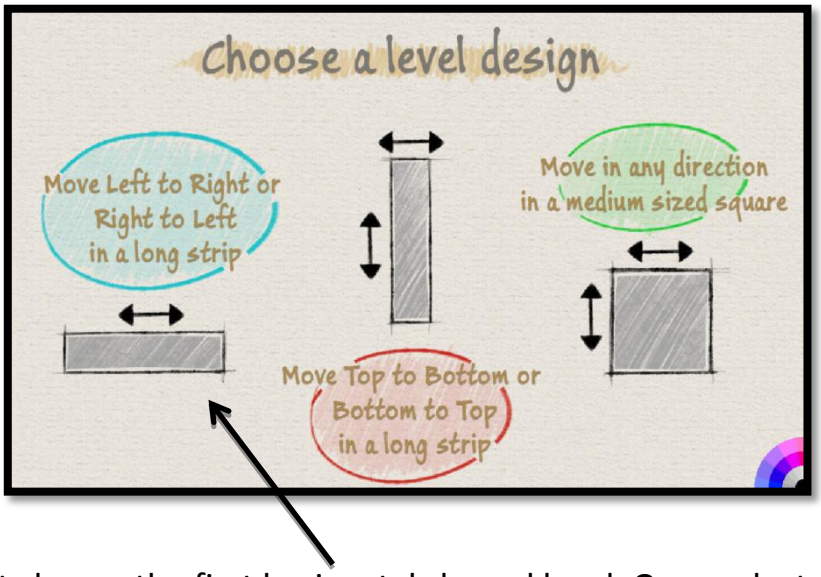
EXIT will take you out of the software, back to Windows.

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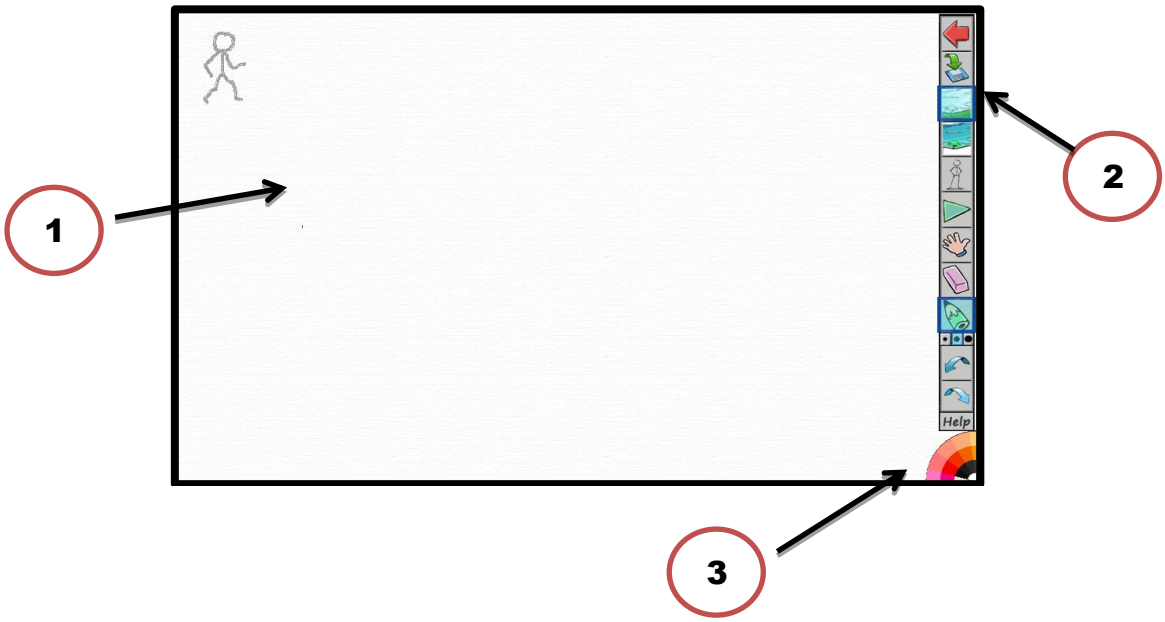
Learning to Doodle!

Follow this user guide and you will soon learn all the features of My Doodle Game as we explore the application and create our first game together.

From the main menu select the NEW option. You will be asked a question about the size of game area you want to work with:



For now, just choose the first horizontal shaped level. Once selected you will be shown the main editing screen:



The screen has three key elements to it.
[1] The white area is where you will doodle your game to life.
[2] The toolbar on the right lets you choose various options.

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[3] The colour wheel at the bottom right lets you choose your choice of doodling colour!

When a fresh game is started it defaults to a platform game with a running hero. This is why the stick man is shown as the first element in the game. You can change this if you want but it's a handy help to get things started.

The right side tool bar needs some explaining before we move on with the game. Let's see what each icon is for.

The Doodle Tool Bar



Back. Click on this icon and you will be taken back to the main menu.



Save game. Simply saves your game in its current state.



Foreground drawing mode. When you draw your game you will need to distinguish between items of your game that let the game characters run around on and those parts of the game that are just back ground designs. The icon shows the hills in full colour, so as you can imagine this is what a game character would run around on.



Background drawing mode. If you want to draw things like trees, houses, clouds and so on, but don't want the game characters to collide with them then you would draw them in this mode. Notice how the tree and sky are coloured in on this icon to indicate this.



Character mode. Click this and you are in character mode. You can then move characters around the game, edit them, remove them or make new ones.

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Play game. Just click this and your game will start instantly. It's great for testing the game at any point of its design.



Drag tool. Click this and then click and hold the game area, then move the mouse around and the game editing area can be scrolled, allowing you to design more areas of your game.



Erase tool. Use this when you want to remove areas of images in the foreground, background or characters.



Draw tool. Click this to draw and design foreground, background and characters. The draw tool uses the most recently selected colour from the colour wheel.



Nib sizes: Select the nib size for the draw and erase tools with this.



Undo. This will undo the last edit made during editing.



Redo. Puts back any change you made with undo.

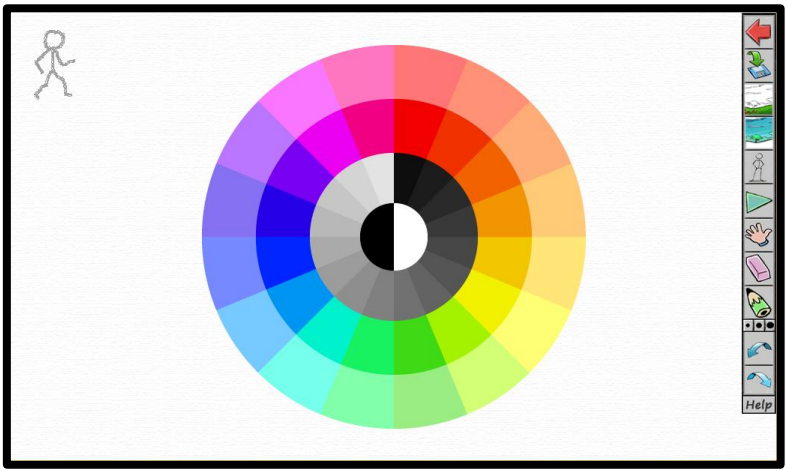


Help: Calls up the help pages from within the editor.

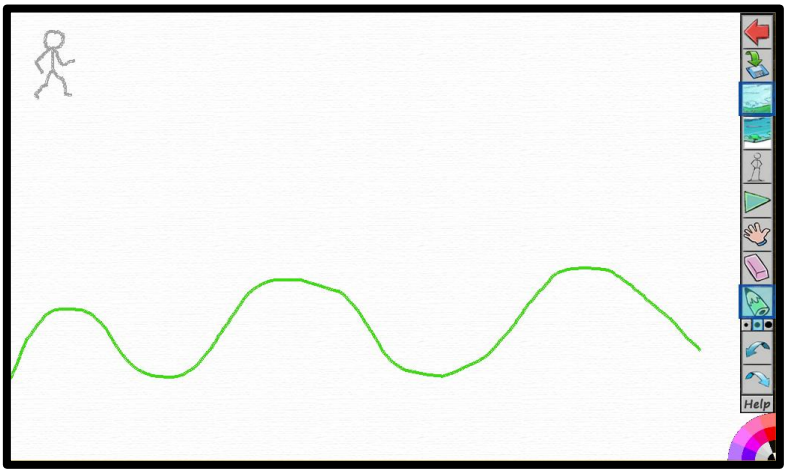
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Foreground Design

With a blank game screen, click on the colour wheel in the bottom right and you will see it zoom up and show this selection of colours:

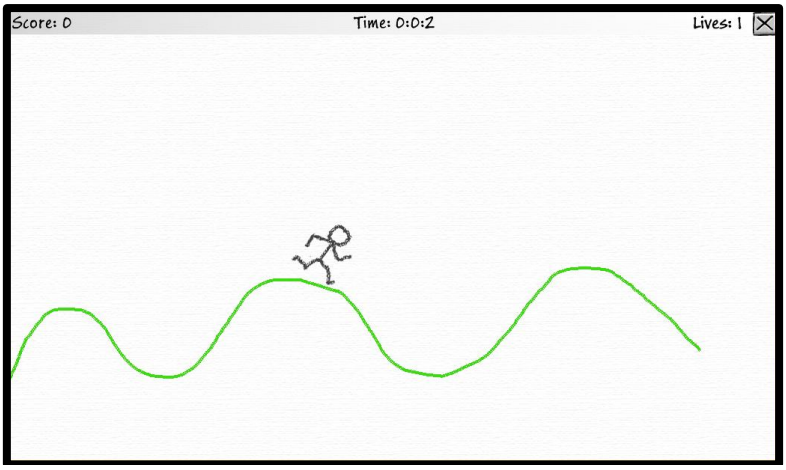


Now choose a green colour. The wheel will zoom back down and you can now draw some hills like this:



Even at this early stage we can try our very simple game. Click on the “Play Game” icon 

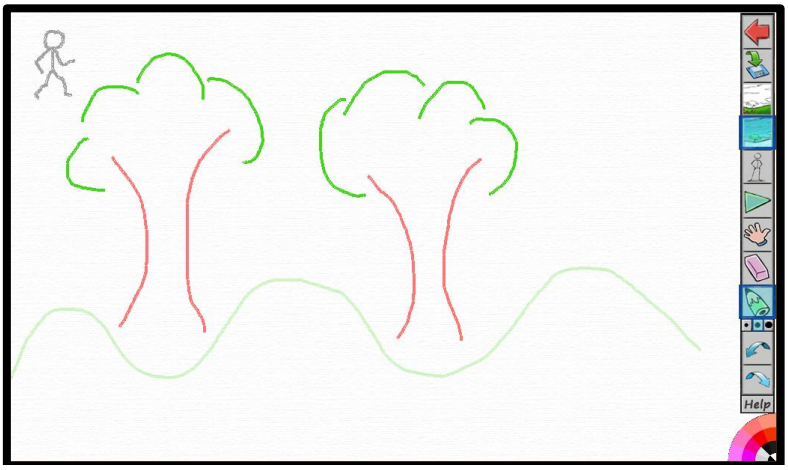
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Now you can run across the hills with the left and right keys on your keyboard. If you run off the end you'll fall to your death, so be careful! ☺

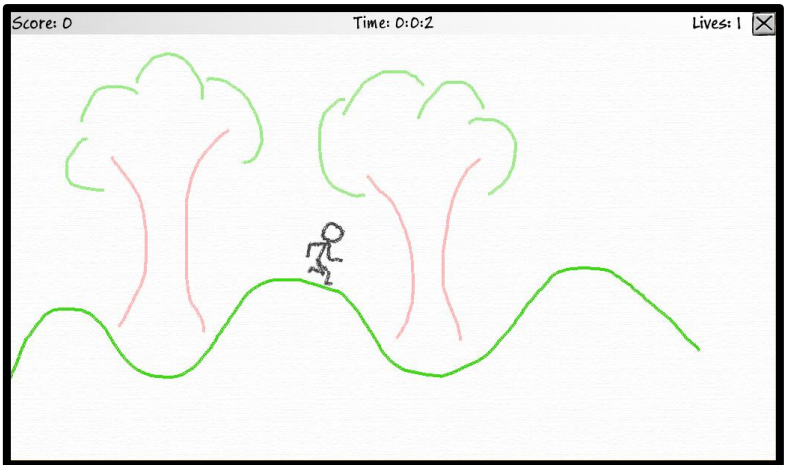
To stop the game, press the ESCape key on the keyboard.

Now we can add some background graphics. We need to add these into the background layer so that it doesn't interfere with the game collision mechanics. So press the background icon  and begin to draw some trees like these:

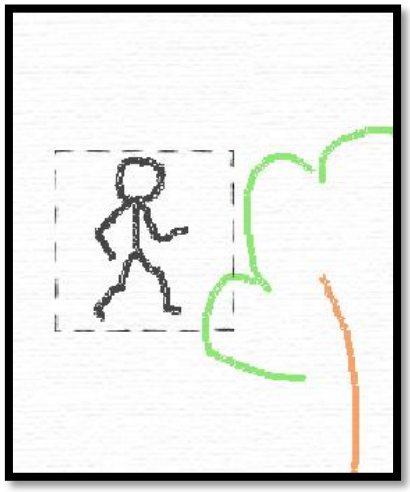


After drawing your background, click on the Play Game icon again and see how the player moves in front of this background layer:

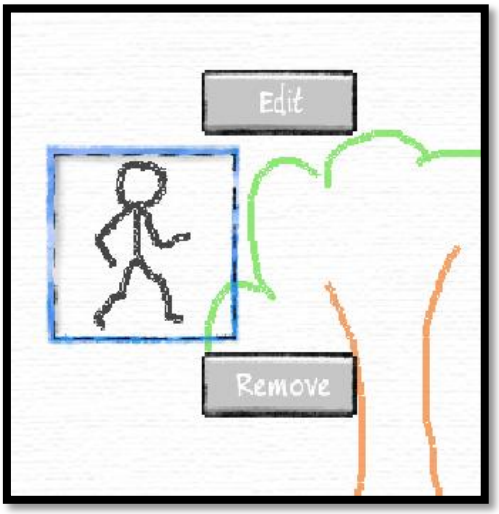
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Let's now take a closer look at the hero character in the game. Click on the Character icon:  . The hero will now have a highlight around him:

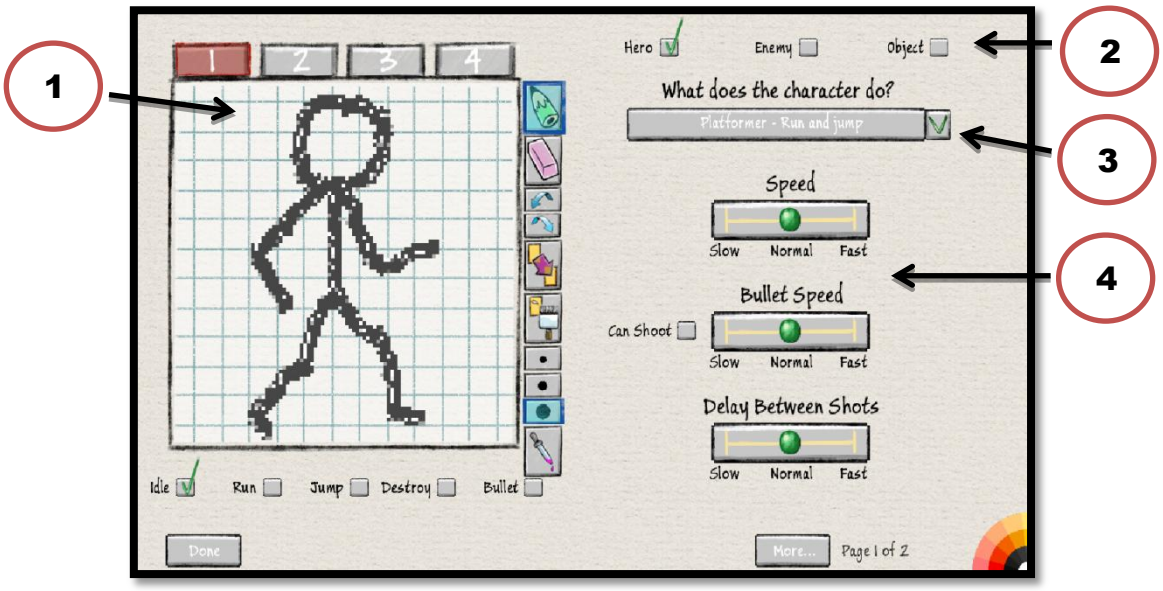


Click on the character and some options will appear around it:



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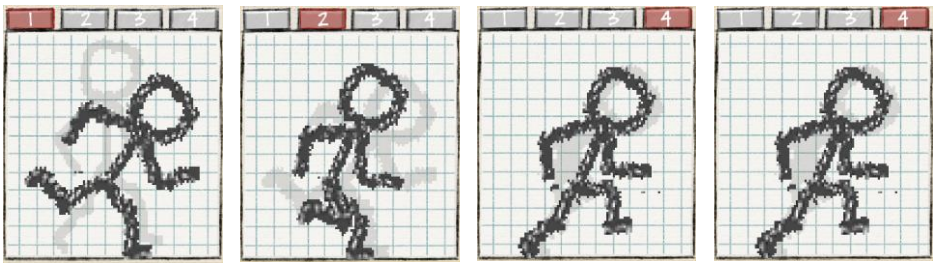
Click on the “EDIT” option and the character animation editor will appear:



At first it seems like a lot to take in but we’re sure you’ll get used to it very quickly. There are four keys areas:

[1] Animation frame editor: This is where you can paint individual frames of animation. At the top you will see four tabs marked 1,2,3 and 4. Just click on these to select any of the four individual frames that make up an animation. At the base of the frame is where you choose which animation you are editing (idle, run, jump, destroy and bullet). This idle animation has just one frame but you can easily add more of you want.

If you select the Run animation you will see that it has four frames:



Notice how the editor shows you a ghost image of the previous frame to help you with the frame by frame animation. Frame 1 shows a ghost of the idle frame.

There are some control icons to the right of the frame, let’s see what these are for;

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 **Draw mode.** This must be highlighted so that you can draw into the frame editing screen. See the nib size icons below - these set how fine or bold the drawing will be.

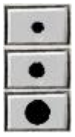
 **Eraser.** Select this to remove mistakes from the frame edit area. The size of the eraser is set via the nib size icons.

 **Undo.** Removes the most recent edit into the frame.

 **Redo.** Will put back what undo just changed.

 **Copy frame.** Will take the current frame and hold it in the copy buffer, you can then paste it into another frame. You might use this tool to make a monster in frame 1, copy it into frame 2 and then make the small movement changes with the eraser and drawing tools.

 **Paste frame.** It puts whatever is in the copy buffer into the current frame being edited.

 **Nib sizes.** The size of drawing nib is set with these three icons. Just choose the size you want and draw. The nib size is also used for the eraser tool.

 **Dropper.** Sometimes you want to edit some graphics but you're not too sure what shade of colour you used in the image. Click this and then click on the colour in the image you want and the draw colour will be set to it.

[2] Type of Object. At the top right you can set what type the object is. This character is a player controlled hero character. You can change it to an enemy

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or an object. Enemy objects attack the player and objects are things like pick-ups, obstacles or animating scenery.

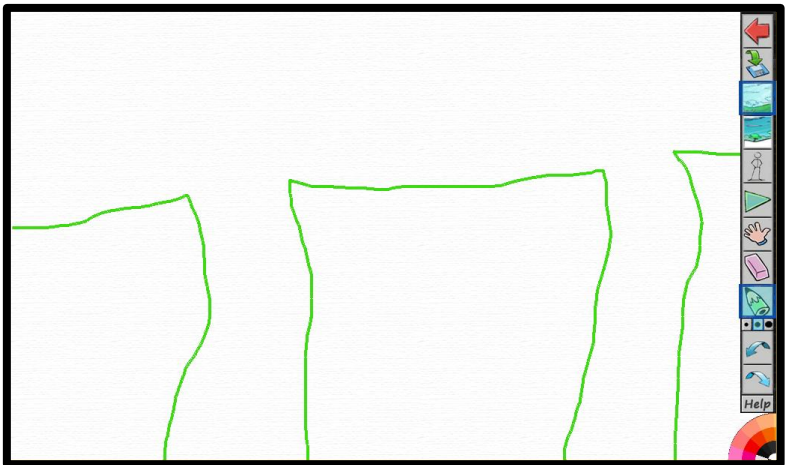
[3] Character Behaviour. This drop down box lets you select how the object behaves. It's currently set to "Platformer – Run and jump". Changing it to "Space Ship / aircraft" will make it fly around the scene as the game plays, changing it significantly. You just need to draw some wings on to our man or make him into a spaceship! This list changes based on the Type of object selected.

[4] Character Properties. This section lists the different properties that you can tweak. From the speed the character can run, to the sound used when the player dies. You'll notice a "MORE" button, click on that to access more properties of this character.

TIP! *My Doodle Game will automatically rotate the frames you create. So you MUST draw the images pointing to the right.*

Moving the game scene

When you are done with exploring the animation editor, click on the "Done" button and come back to the main game editing screen. Now click on the drag tool icon  and then click and drag the game screen to reveal more white space to the right. You can now click on the foreground icon and draw some more game area like this:



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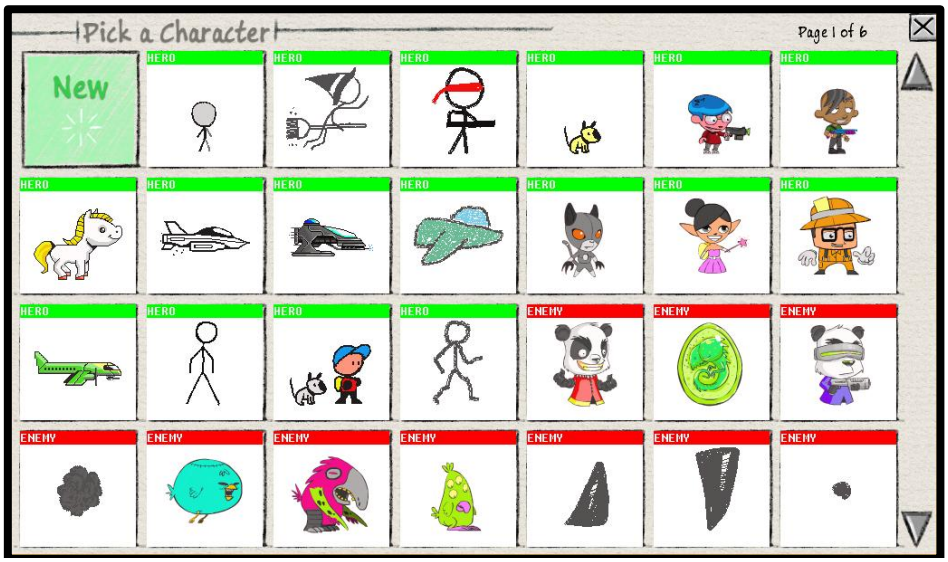
Now let's add an enemy to the game and draw it from scratch.

Click on the character icon  and it will change into this icon with a highlight:

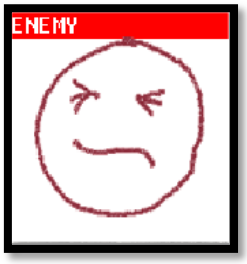

Click on this icon and you can add an existing character to your game or create a new one.

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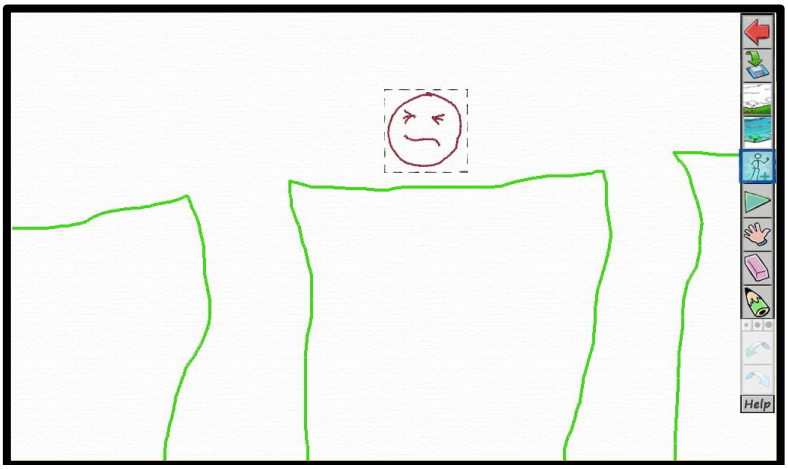
This is the sort of screen you will see:



For now scroll down to page 4 and pick the round faced enemy:

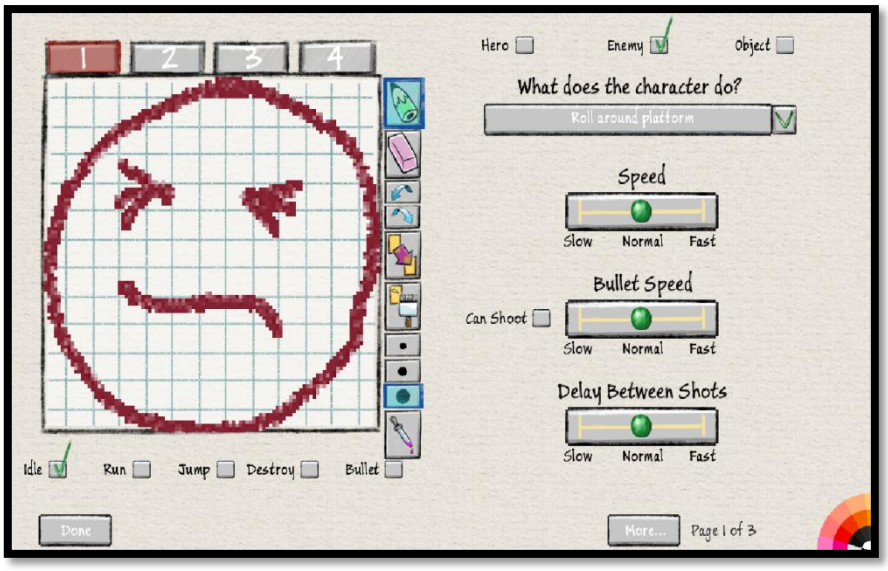


Place the enemy into the game at about this position:

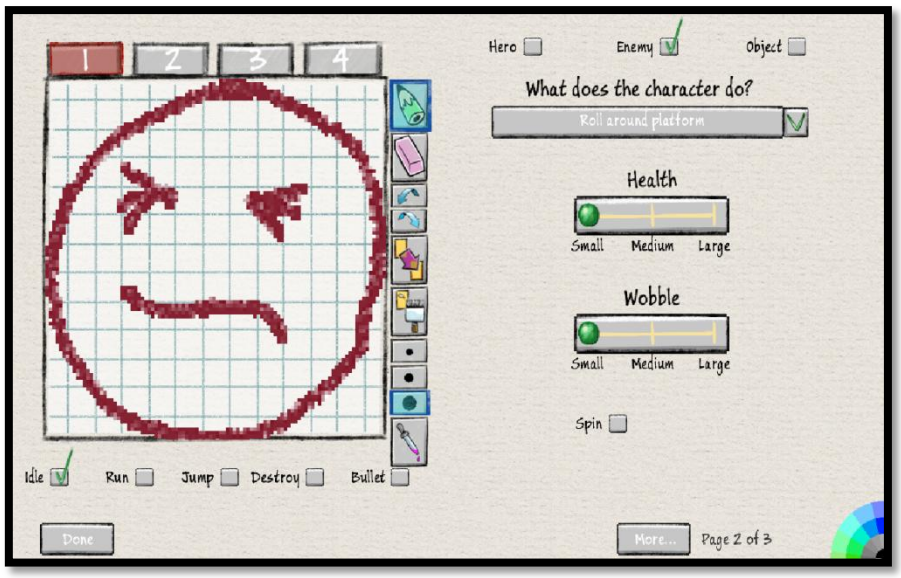


If you click on the enemy and edit it, you'll see that it's set to be an enemy and has "Roll around platform" as its Artificial Intelligence (AI). This means it will follow any platform it might be on or near, from one end to the other.

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Clicking on the “More…” button reveals more of the enemy’s properties;



Now put your own design into this character. Pick a colour and give the enemy a nose of any shape you like. When you’re happy with your design click on the “Done” button and play the game.

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Parameters you can change
Here's a breakdown of the various parameters you can change to customise how characters behave in your game.

Hero Character

There are two types of Hero player characters;

1. *Platformer*. Character will move left and right across any foreground you have drawn and is affected by gravity. The hero can also jump and shoot.
2. *Spaceship*. This type flies around the screen and acts like a space ship or flying plane.

Either of the above types can have these settings;

- Speed – affects the speed the hero moves
- Bullet speed – sets the speed of any bullet the hero shoots
- ✓Can shoot – if ticked it will allow the character to shoot bullets
- Delay between shots – the time between each bullet being shot
- Game music – choose an MP3 file and it will play during your game
- Bullet sound – the sound (wav file) the bullet makes when the hero shoot
- Jump sound – when the player jumps it will play this sound
- Destroy sound – if the character gets killed by an enemy or bullet, this sound will play

TIP! *Note that bullets for the hero are drawn in the bullet frame of the character. This also applies to enemy characters.*

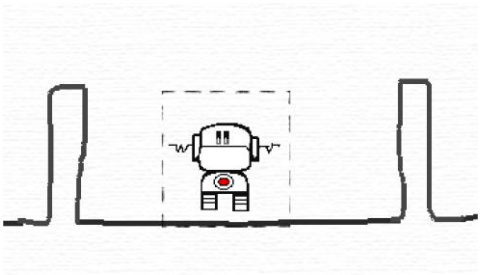
Enemy Character

Enemies come in all shapes and sizes (if you draw them that way!) My Doodle Game also provides a range of ways to control them (their AI).

1. Patrol platform – the enemy will move left and right across any foreground under where they start the game.
2. Roll around platform – this is similar to patrol platform but in this case the enemy rotates as it moves. Ideal for round and blobby type enemies.
3. Fly left – in space shooters you will want UFO ships attacking you. So this movement allows an enemy to fly onto the screen from the right and move across to the left.
4. Fly Right – this will make enemies fly from the left to the right.

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5. Fly Patrol Horizontal – this AI lets you setup an enemy that will move left and right in between two areas of scenery. You must make sure there are two foreground areas for the object to move between; otherwise it will just keep flying off the screen. Here's an example of how you might draw it;



6. Fly Patrol Vertical – this moves an enemy up and down between scenery items.
7. Circle around the screen – an enemy moving this way will circle the player and make it harder for the player to destroy.
8. Static – Use this setting to create obstacles that can hurt the player (like spikes and fire). An enemy set to this AI will not move but can be an interesting game element for the player to avoid.

All these enemy types can have these settings;

- Speed – the speed of the enemy
- Bullet speed – the speed of the enemy's bullets
- ✓Can shoot – tick it off and enemies will not shoot
- Delay between shots – time between each shot
- Health – the health of the enemy. Set the health high to make it harder to destroy
- Wobble – adds a wobble movement to the enemy, making it harder to shoot down
- ✓Spin – if ticked the enemy's that fly will spin around (great for objects like asteroids)
- Bullet sound – the wav file played when the enemy shoots
- Jump sound – this is not applicable at present. In future enemies could be able to jump and you would set the sound here
- Destroy sound – the death cry of the enemy

Object

These types are for things like the end of level marker or pick up items.

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1. Exit – this could be a door way where the player has to reach to complete the game. As soon as the hero character gets to this object the game is won.

2. Collectable – you can design coins, stars, gems and other typical game objects that hero characters need to collect during their adventure.

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Frequently Asked Questions

What sort of games can I make?
This first version of My Doodle Game is focused on making Platformer games and scrolling shooter games. We plan to add new features to future versions which will expand the scope of the games you can make.

My Hero jumps through the scenery, how can I fix it?
Simply add more lines of scenery to areas where this happens. A single line might not be enough for the game's collision system.

Enemies sometimes flicker and get stuck, how can I stop that?
My Doodle Game tries to work out the best route for enemies that follow a platform. The best practise is to ensure hills and inclines and smooth and not too steep. We also recommend you ensure platform edges are drawn with right angled edges.

Can I have more than one Hero Character?
You can only have one hero. If you have more than one the game will just choose the first one it finds and use that. Any other hero characters will be made static.

Why is there more than one version of the same character in the library?
Every time you edit a character My Doodle Game makes a totally new copy of it. A small graphic change or just a new AI behaviour will force this to happen. This has to happen so that the original versions and not changed and to ensure games you have already made are not modified.

Can I make multi-levelled games?
Not with this version. This is a feature we will add in a future version.

Can I use my own music files?
Yes! My Doodle Game loads .mp3 music files. If you copy your preferred music file into the folder shown below, you will be able to select it in page 2 of the hero properties under "Game Music";

```
C:\Program Files\Omnisoft\My Doodle Game\Media\Music\
```

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How can I use my own sound files?
My Doodle Game loads .wav sound files. If you copy your preferred sound files into the folder shown below, you will be able to select it in the character properties;

```
C:\Program Files\Omnisoft\My Doodle Game\Media\sfx\
```

I have an advanced art application. Can I use that with My Doodle Game?
Take a look at the file structure here;

```
C:\Program Files\Omnisoft\My Doodle Game\games\
```

Inside that folder you will see a list of folders starting from 1 and counting up. Each one of these is a full game. Look inside the game you want to work on and you will see some files and a folder called “scenery”. Inside “scenery” are the images that make up your game. They are labelled b0 to b8 and f0 to f8. “b” for background and “f” for foreground. You can edit any of these images and the next time you load your game into My Doodle Game you will see the changes you made.

To save disk space, the images are blank until they have been edited in My Doodle Game. So we recommend that you draw your game in My Doodle Game first and then make the edits in your choice of paint program. It will also be much clearer how the images stitch together if you do it this way.

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